JULIAN TSANG

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EDUCATION

University of Chicago, USA · *Non-degree coursework* Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Analysis in $\mathbb{R}^n$ I: A; ranked 1st in the final exam (77/80) among 30 students

University of Oxford, UK · *MPhil in Economics* Sep 2023 – Jun 2025

- Graduated with *Distinction* (US GPA equivalent: 4.0/4.0)
- Relevant courses (70+ is Distinction level): Core Microeconomics (82/100), Core Econometrics (73/100), Core Macroeconomics (70/100), and Advanced Econometrics (73/100), a PhD-level course covering asymptotics and measure theory
- Thesis: "Patronage or Purge? The Economic Impact of Elite Connections in China's Leadership Transition" (supervised by Prof. Noam Yuchtman)

University College London, UK · *BSc Economics* Sep 2020 – Jun 2023

- Graduated with *First Class Honours*, ranked 30th of 499 (top 6%); average of 76/100 (US GPA equivalent: 4.0/4.0)
- Quantitative courses: Statistical Methods in Economics (94/100), Mathematics for Economics (86/100), and Game Theory (82/100)

RESEARCH

"Process Efficiency as a Barrier to Innovation" · *Working paper* 2026

- Built a dynamic model of firm innovation with two uses of R&D: *product innovation*, through which a firm acquires new product lines, and *process efficiency*, the capabilities a firm builds to lower costs on all product lines it owns. Large firms tilt their R&D toward process efficiency, creating an externality that crowds out product innovation by smaller firms
- The model predicts that R&D subsidies to large firms strengthen this externality. Found support for this prediction in firm-level data from the Chinese Tax Survey, with results robust to a shift-share instrument based on provincial patterns in subsidy allocation. Calibrated to the Chinese economy, where R&D subsidies currently favor large firms, the model implies a 10.7% gain in consumption-equivalent welfare from reallocating subsidies

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Professional, Becker Friedman Institute · *University of Chicago* Jul 2025 – Present

- Worked with Profs. Rossi-Hansberg and Hsieh to build and calibrate a dynamic model of firm innovation featuring internal and external innovation, firm heterogeneity, and endogenous entry and exit. The model explores the sources of firm concentration in the U.S. with comparison to India and Mexico
- Extended the spatial integrated assessment model of Cruz and Rossi-Hansberg (2024) to include a collapse of the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation. Found that the collapse lowers welfare on net but reverses the welfare losses for the regions hardest hit by climate change
- Worked with an extension of the dynamic spatial model of Desmet et al. (2025) that endogenizes the cost of human capital accumulation, using it to predict income convergence across space over the very long run
- Assisted with the revise-and-resubmit of "Local GDP Estimates Around the World" (Rossi-Hansberg and Zhang, 2026), leading to its acceptance by the *Journal of Urban Economics*. Designed uncertainty measures for the GDP estimates and a variable-importance method to decompose the factors contributing to GDP divergence across grid cells

Research Assistant to Prof. Shaoda Wang · *University of Chicago* Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- Worked on a project on how government arrests in China affect entrepreneur sentiment and firm financial outcomes, using LLMs and unsupervised methods to construct sentiment scores from over 150 million social media posts by entrepreneurs
- Classified entrepreneurs on a left-right political spectrum based on the views they expressed on social media, and ran LASSO and event studies to identify the drivers of shifts in political attitudes

Research Assistant to Prof. David Yang · *Harvard University* Apr 2024 – Feb 2025

- Contributed to a study of Chinese government-guided investment funds by collecting their policy documents online and using LLMs to construct variables on the funds' investment mandates

- Measured the industrial policy focus of Chinese regional governments, using LLMs to extract variables from their annual reports and five-year plans

Research Assistant to Prof. Andrea Bernini · *University of Oxford* Jan 2024 – Sep 2024

- Contributed to the revise-and-resubmit of a paper on NAFTA's effect on income inequality in Mexico, addressing the referees' concerns about its identification strategy and limitations
- Wrote a section of a paper that studies the effect of the 1990 German reunification on gender differences in smoking in East Germany

OTHER EXPERIENCE

RBB Economics (economic consultancy), London, UK · *Intern* Jun 2024 – Sep 2024

- Worked on a UK steel merger, cleaning sales data to show the closeness of competition between the merging parties in response to information requests from the Competition and Markets Authority

Capital Pilot (venture capital firm), London, UK · *Consultant* Apr 2022 – Jun 2023

- Evaluated early-stage startups and developed metrics adopted in the firm's investment rating system

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

UCL Mahjong Society, London, UK · *President* Sep 2022 – Jun 2023

- Organized weekly sessions and introduced the East Asian game to members, explaining its complex rules to beginners
- Launched the first London inter-university mahjong contest, organized jointly with LSE, KCL, and Imperial

UCL Data Science Society, London, UK · *Quantitative Researcher* Oct 2021 – Jun 2022

- Organized workshops explaining the basics of econometrics and machine learning, including OLS, LASSO, and random forests
- Mentored new members through their first data projects, from cleaning data to running regressions in Python

AWARDS AND HONORS

- Distinction, MPhil in Economics (University of Oxford, 2025)
- First Class Honours, BSc Economics (University College London, 2023)
- Finalist, UCL Explore Econ research competition (2022 and 2023)
- A* in all four International A-Levels (Highest Mark in the World for Economics, 2020)
- Second Place, Hong Kong Inter-School Economic Analysis Competition (Hong Kong Association for Economics Education, 2020)

REFERENCES

Prof. Esteban Rossi-Hansberg
Glen A. Lloyd Distinguished Service Professor
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
University of Chicago
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Prof. Chang-Tai Hsieh
Phyllis and Irwin Winkelried Distinguished Service Professor of Economics
Booth School of Business
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chsieh@chicagobooth.edu

Prof. Klaus Desmet
Ruth and Kenneth Altshuler Centennial Interdisciplinary Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
Southern Methodist University
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Prof. Juanma Castro-Vincenzi
Assistant Professor
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
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MISCELLANEOUS

- **Programming:** MATLAB, Python, Julia, R, Stata, Dynare, ArcGIS, and LaTeX
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Cantonese (native), and Mandarin
- **Interests:** Tennis, Climbing, Volunteering, and Traveling to Ethnic Minority Areas in China